

Incredible India

Uttar Pradesh

UTTAR PRADESH TOURISM

U.P. nahi dekha,
toh India nahi dekha.

Shravasti





Jetavana Vihara

Shravasti

Shravasti (ancient Savatthi) was the capital city of the kingdom of Kosala. It was a beautiful city in the Gangetic plains with vast amounts of agriculture and diversity. The Buddha spent 25 rainy seasons (vassāvāsa) here. Thus, Shravasti is the place where the Buddha lived the longest amount of time and most of the Buddha's Teachings had been taught here. The Twin Miracle and many other historical events took place in and around Shravasti. Of particular importance, it is the place where millions of humans, devas and brahmas attained enlightenment, especially during the Buddha's time.



A sandstone panel from Bharhut in central India, showing the purchase of the Jetavana Vihara in Shravasti.



And the rulers and citizens of many countries vied with one another in making offerings at Jetavana Vihara, hanging silk pennants and canopies, scattering flowers and lighting lamps, which burnt day and night without ever being extinguished.

Fa Hien
5th century AD



Gandhakuti

Sahet (Jetavana)

During the time of the Buddha, Sudatta, also known as **Anathapindika**, was a rich and pious merchant of Shravasti. While on a business trip to Rajgir, he heard the Buddha's sermon and became a faithful disciple, a layman with unshakable faith in the Buddha's dispensation.

Sudatta invited the Buddha to Shravasti and began to look for a suitable place to build a vihara. A beautiful park at the southern edge of the city belonged to Prince Jeta, son of the King Prasenjit of Shravasti. Prince Jeta demanded that Sudatta cover the entire park with gold coins. Sudatta meticulously paved every inch of the land with gold coins, left only a small area for the archway uncovered. When the Prince realised this noble act of charity, he requested to donate the remaining plot and built the archway of the monastery. Thus, the Vihara was known as **Jetavana, Anathapindika's monastery**.





Anathapindika spent a total of 54 crores (540 millions) in gold coins to purchase the land, to construct the Buddha's dwelling, the Gandhakuti, all other buildings and facilities, including the celebration of the magnificent monastery for 9 months.





One of the most auspicious spots in Jetavana is the **Ananda Bodhi Tree**. According to Buddhist history, one of the two Chief Disciples of the Buddha, Venerable Maha Mogallana brought the seed from the original sacred Maha Bodhi Tree in Bodhgaya, and was planted by Anathapindika under the direction of Venerable Ananda, who received permission from the Buddha. It miraculously grew into a big tree. In order to consecrate it, the Buddha spent one night under the tree, radiating loving-kindness and blessings. This Bodhi Tree became the place of devotion for all Buddhists around the world.



Shobhnath Temple



Mahet

Located on the banks of the river Archiravati (Rapti), the city of Shravasti had a high earthen rampart with a brick wall running along a circuit of 5.23 km. and pierced by several gates distinguished by high bastions. Four main gates are known as Imli Darwaza, Rajgarh Darwaza, Naushahra Darwaza and Kand bhari Darwaza situated respectively at the south-west, north-west, north-east and south-east corners. The remains within the city area include Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain structures and a few medieval tombs.

Tourists flow in huge numbers to offer obeisance to the Buddha.



The most significant structure among them are the **Temple of Shobhnath, Pakki Kuti and Kachchi Kuti**. The Shobhnath temple is located just near the entrance from western side, represents the remains of a Jain temple, the domed edifice on the top being a superimposition in medieval period. The spot is hallowed as the birth place of Sambhavnath, the third Jain Tirthankara. Excavation in the nearby area has exposed remains of 3 temple complexes. The scientific clearance of the place has yielded a few sculptures of Jain Tirthankaras in standing and seated posture datable to 10th – 11th century besides exposing the lower portions of the Jain temple.



Pakki Kuti

Pakki Kuti and Kachchi Kuti

Pakki Kuti is said to be the home of Angulimala's parents. Angulimala means "Garland of fingers". His original name was Ahimsaka, which means "harmless". He received higher education in Takkasila, the famous ancient university, he was wrongly encouraged to kill 1,000 people in order to complete his studies. When Angulimala collected 999 fingers, and without knowing, he would even kill his own mother as the last person to complete his mission. The Buddha, aware of the severe karmic consequences of such a great sin that Angulimala would have to face, headed towards the place. With supernormal power and words of wisdom, the Buddha caused a change of heart leading Angulimala to give up his cruel ways and become a Bhikkhu disciple of the Buddha and ultimately attained liberation. The structure of Pakki Kuti has undergone a number of subsequent alterations and additions over the time.



Angulimala Cave

Kachchi Kuti is situated a few meters towards the south-east direction of Pakki Kuti. Excavations from this site revealed that this structure dated back to Kushana Period and was associated with Anathapindika's home. During the Buddha's time, every day several hundred monks from Jetavana came to receive the forenoon meal and therefore his home was filled with saffron robes and the ambience of saintliness.



Sala Brahmachariya Buad Chai (Hall for the Holy Life and Ordain the Heart)
Main Meditation Hall, Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland

Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland

In 1994, Maha Upasika Dr. Bongkot Sitthipol of Thailand made a resolute determination to do the meritorious work for true peace and happiness to the whole world. In veneration of perseverance, she built the Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland, Shravasti as an international Meditation Centre, a centre of learning for people from all over the world to train in the supreme merit of renunciation, mind cultivation, the holy life and Ordaining the Heart, and established **“Mahamongkolchai Dhamma Devoted Land for World Peacefulness Foundation”**.

It is a unique experience for visitors to Shravasti, where all can come to learn, practise basic meditation, generate virtues and wisdom for peace and true happiness in the family and society. The entire area has been developed into a natural lush green forest, serene and tranquil, surrounded by canals and ponds.

The devotees and volunteers are committed to selfless service for the peace and happiness of humanity and promote lifelong non-formal education and other charitable activities. The eco-friendly dwelling, management and lifestyle of the Dhamma practitioners at this Meditation Centre inculcates within the visitors a sense of inner peace, selfless dedication for the common good, respect for and in harmony with Mother Nature and compassion for all beings.





Mahamongkolchai Buddha
of great loving-kindness bestows blessings
for the true essence of supreme peace and highest happiness
to the whole world

The magnificent Buddha Statue in the bestow blessings gesture
at Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland, Shravasti, U.P.

This Buddha Statue was built in **2004**.
Maha Upasika Dr. Bongkot Sitthipol was the director of the construction.



The Buddha's Mahamongkolchai Stupa in deep gratitude and devotion to Dhamma for Peace in the World

The Buddha's Mahamongkolchai Stupa arose with the intention to express deep gratitude and devotion to the benevolence of the Noble Triple Gem.

The Stupa was built in **2007** and is **111.99** meters high.

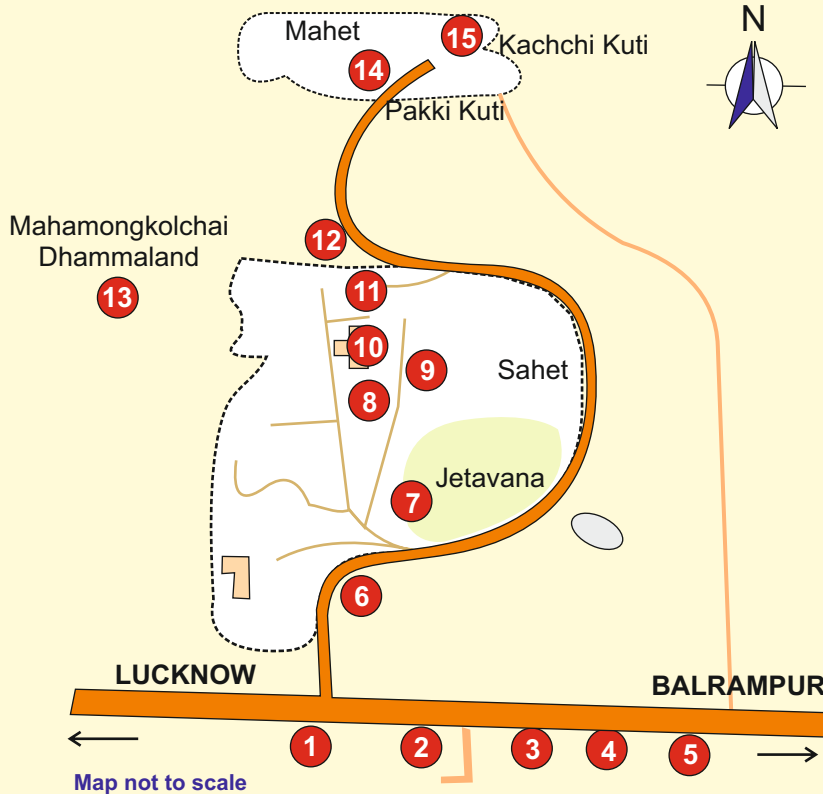
Maha Upasika Dr. Bongkot Sitthipol was the director of all construction work and led her devotees and volunteers to sacrifice themselves in goodwill and great harmony in building the Stupa.

This Stupa is the highest Stupa ever built in Shravasti and Uttar Pradesh.



Sala Brahmachariya Buad Chai (Hall for the Holy Life and Ordain the Heart)
Main Meditation Hall, Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland

Location Map of places to see at Shravasti



1. Cambodian Buddhist Temple
2. Sri Lankan guest house
3. Jain Temple
4. UP Tourist Bungalow
5. Japanese Bell Temple
6. Sri Lankan Temple
7. Anandabodhi Tree
8. Anandakuti
9. Ancient Wall
10. Gandhakuti
11. Ticket Office
12. Chinese Temple
13. Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland
14. Pakki Kuti (Angulimala's Stupa)
15. Kachchi Kuti (Sudatta's Stupa)

World Peace Bell



Close to Jetavana are the Sri Lankan, Chinese, Myanmar (Burmese) and Thai monasteries and temples. Also worth seeing is the park with a large bell donated by Japanese pilgrims.

Tourist Information

Accommodation:

Hotel Lotus Nikko, Tel. 05252-265291-93, Rahi Tourist Bungalow (U.P.S.T.D.C.), Katra, Shravasti, Tel. ; 05252-265302 e mail: rahitbshravasti@up-tourism.com; Rahi Tourist Bungalow (U.P.S.T.D.C.), Balrampur Tel: 05263-232456, Hotel Pawan Palace, Tel.: 9451744076, Buddha Resort (40 km.: Shravasti-Lucknow Road), Bahraich, Tel: 05252-231531, Shravasti Residency, Sravasti : Tel. : 7234914233

Other Accommodation:

Inspection Bangalow, PWD
Burmese Temple, Rest house.
Chinese Temple Rest House.
Jain Darmashala.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Tourist Bungalow Campus, Balrampur, Tel: 05263-232456

Near by Buddhist Places:

Lumbini (165 km.-Nepal), Kapilvastu (198km.)

How to Reach:

The convenient rail/air terminal is at Lucknow (176/186 km.) Rail travel is possible upto Balrampur (17 km.) from where one can reach Shravasti by bus or taxi. Some important road distances are: Bahraich-48 km., Lumbini-165 km., Gorakhpur- 196 km., Kushinagar - 247 km., Kapilvastu- 198 km., Varanasi- 306 km., Sarnath- 315 km.

Buddhist Circuit Uttar Pradesh INDIA

New Delhi

NEPAL

Shravasti

Lumbini

Lucknow

Sankisa

Kapilvastu

Gorakhpur

Kushinagar

Prayagraj

Kaushambi

Sarnath

Varanasi

Uttar Pradesh

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**U.P. nahi dekha,
toh India nahi dekha.**



Sarnath



Kushinagar



Kapilvastu



Sankisa



Kaushambi

Uttar Pradesh is in the north of India and next to Nepal, it deserves to be called the “Cradle of Buddhism” more than any other region in the world. In this Holy land, the Buddha was born in Lumbini, Nepal; grew up as a prince and renounced all royal property and status to live the homeless life; preached his first sermon in Sarnath; and passed into Mahaparinirvana in Kushinagar. Come to Uttar Pradesh and discover the glorious legacy and walk along the foot-steps of the Buddha.

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